Tutorial: PM Lifecycle & Process Groups

Project Scenario: Smart Campus App

Your university's IT department has been asked to build a mobile and web application, “Smart Campus”, for the university community. The system must allow:

- Students to view timetables, register for exams, and receive attendance/absence notifications.
- Lecturers to mark attendance digitally and post announcements.
- Administration to manage room and facility bookings and track usage analytics.

The project has a fixed academic-year budget and must be piloted with one faculty before a university-wide rollout. Key stakeholders include the IT department, faculty deans, lecturers, students, and the university's IT security team, since data-protection compliance is mandatory.

Task 1: Identify the Project's Characteristics

Explain how the Smart Campus App demonstrates each characteristic of a project. Be specific to this project — avoid generic definitions.

Characteristic	How it applies to the Smart Campus App
Temporary Nature	
Unique Output	
Progressive Elaboration	
Value Delivery Focus	

Task 2: Map the Project Lifecycle

For each lifecycle phase, identify one key activity and one concrete deliverable specific to the Smart Campus App.

Phase	Key Activity for This Project	Deliverable
Initiation		
Planning		
Execution		

Monitoring & Controlling		
Closing		

Task 3: Process Groups in Action

For each process group, list two specific activities the project team would carry out for the Smart Campus App, and one output/document that would result.

Process Group	Two Project-Specific Activities	One Expected Output
Initiating		
Planning		
Executing		
Monitoring & Controlling		
Closing		

Task 4: Anticipate Challenges & Best Practices

Identify two realistic challenges this project could face, and one best practice from the lecture that would address each one.

Challenge Specific to This Project	Best Practice to Address It

Task 5: Reflect & Discuss

Answer briefly in your own words (2–3 sentences each).

1. Which two of the 12 PMBOK 7 principles matter most for the Smart Campus App, and why?

2. Which performance domain (e.g. Stakeholder, Uncertainty, Team) needs the most attention in this project, and why?

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3. In one sentence, explain the difference between the project lifecycle and the process groups — using this project as your example.
